

AKANKSHA PAWAR

UI/UX Designer · UX Researcher · Interaction Design

 [Portfolio](#)

in [Linkedin](#)

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PROFILE

UI/UX designer in my final year at MIT Institute of Design, driven by curiosity about how products fail people. I actively look for friction in everyday apps and flows, then work backward through user interviews, research, and iteration to design screens that genuinely solve the problem. I care about tangible outcomes, not just polished visuals.

CORE SKILLS

User interviews · Personas · Surveys · Contextual inquiry · Competitive analysis · Heuristic evaluation · Usability testing · A/B testing · Journey & empathy mapping · UI design · Information Architecture · User flows & wireframing · Prototyping · Mobile app design · Design systems · Visual design & typography · Figma Make · Figma Sites · HTML · CSS

TOOLS

Figma · FigJam · Photoshop · Illustrator · Canva · VS Code · Xcode · Android Studio · ChatGPT · Claude

OTHER SKILLS

Illustration · Branding · Brand strategy · Logo & brand identity design · Layout design · Visual hierarchy · Grid systems · Color palette design · Iconography · Photo editing · Dashboard & data UI design · Vibe coding (AI-assisted, to support design work) · Critical thinking · Presentation & communication · Team collaboration

EXPERIENCE

UI/UX Design Intern — Jio Assurance, Reliance Jio Platforms Ltd.

(May 2026 – Jul 2026)

Live product: [JioSphere Browser \(Web, iOS, Android, STB\)](#) · [Figma](#), [FigJam](#) · [Mumbai](#)

- Ran a heuristic evaluation and usability testing of the JioSphere browser across four platforms (Web, iOS, Android, STB) against Nielsen's heuristics, flagging and ranking issues by severity.
- Reworked the information architecture and built low- to high-fidelity wireframes for all four platforms based on what the evaluation turned up.
- Took the Desktop redesign from concept to an interactive Figma prototype, presenting the proposed UX changes to stakeholders.
- Managed my own timeline and walked my mentor through design decisions in regular check-ins.

Freelance UI/UX Designer — Lookout (Driver Safety Monitoring App)

(2025)

Funded IoT + ML product · [Figma](#) · [Pune](#)

- Sole designer on a funded IoT + ML product, covering everything from brand identity to production-ready screens handed off to engineering.
- Built the brand identity (logo, name, colour palette) and 15+ screens across light/dark mode and iOS/Android, including onboarding, dashboard, and live monitor flows.
- Designed a real-time safety analytics dashboard that turns raw IoT sensor data into performance scores, alert breakdowns, and trend graphs.
- Designed a live monitor screen combining dashcam feed with real-time alert overlays, kept simple enough to read at a glance under pressure; this shipped in the live product.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Design for Special Needs

[UX Research & Mobile App Design](#) · [MIT ADT University](#)

- Conducted primary and secondary research on the behavioural, sensory, and learning needs of children on the autism spectrum.
- Identified key challenges around learning, communication, sensory stimulation, and navigation.
- Translated research insights into user flows and design opportunities, developing Ishaara, an autism-support mobile app.
- Designed key features including interactive learning, AR scanning, visual guidance, and community support.

Astra - Behavioral Interaction System for Ethical AI

[UX Research & Interaction Design](#) · [MIT ADT University](#)

- Researched emotional dependence and parasocial attachment among young adults using AI for emotional support.
- Identified challenges around AI dependency, emotional validation, avoidance, and reduced real-world interaction.
- Developed Astra, an AI interaction system designed to help users gain clarity and maintain healthier boundaries with AI.
- Designed the Mirror → Reframe → Redirect framework to encourage self-awareness, autonomy, and real-world connection.

LEADERSHIP & CAMPUS INVOLVEMENT

Graphic Design Team Member

[Natak Bitak Drama Club](#), [MIT Institute of Design](#)

- Designed posters and social media creatives for college productions, keeping event branding consistent under tight deadlines.
- As a senior member, reviewed and approved junior designers' work, checking layouts and timelines to keep the team on track for event deadlines.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design (B.Des) in UI/UX Design

[MIT ADT University](#) · [Loni Kalbhor, Pune](#)

2023 – 2027

Currently in 4th Year